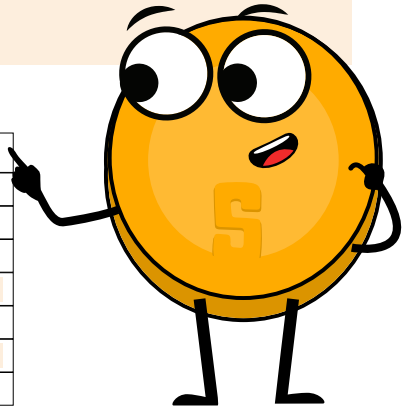
When Jim clicks "send," his wallet uses his **private key** to unlock 0.5 BTC, as this is how he "signs" the transaction. He **does not actually reveal his private key** though.

- By doing this, Jim is informing the network "**I am the owner of this account and I approve the transfer of 0.5 *bitcoin* to Eliana's account**."



LEDGER

Account Owner	Value
Sam	2.50
Adam	3.00
Michael	6.00
Jim	1.50
Robert	2.00
Eliana	1.75
Daniel	5.25

Bitcoin Transaction Request Message

Jim sends 0.50 BTC to Eilana

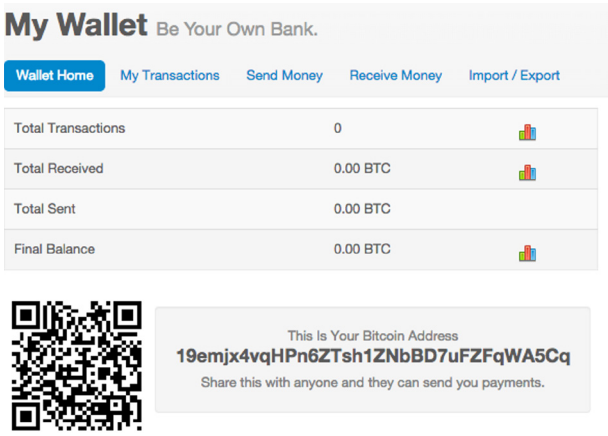
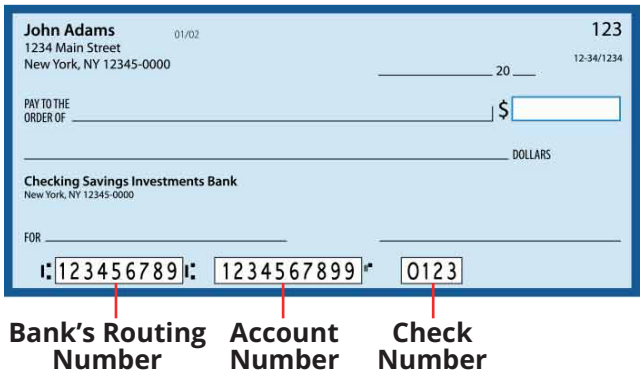
Jim ▸ Eilana 0.50 BTC

LEDGER

Account Owner	Value
Sam	2.50
Adam	3.00
Michael	6.00
Jim	**1.00**
Robert	2.00
Eliana	**2.25**
Daniel	5.25

3. After signing the transaction, it is **broadcast** to the network where it is verified by nodes called miners. Miners check the transaction for validity and ensure that Jim has enough funds. If he does not, they reject the transaction immediately.
4. Once the transaction is verified and included in a block, it is added to the *blockchain*, and the funds are transferred to Eliana's address.
5. Eliana can then use her **private key** to access the transferred funds in his wallet.

It's important to note that once the transaction is complete, it cannot be reversed.

Now with a bit of detail

After opening his digital wallet, Jim, via his own address, initiates the transaction by requesting and including Eliana's bitcoin address (similar to writing a routing number for a traditional bank transfer) and the amount of ***bitcoin*** to be sent. Jim signs the transaction with his **private key** (similar to accessing an account with a private password) to validate the transfer.